

Authentication and Authorization

Login, sessions, cookies, tokens, JWT, OAuth, OIDC, SSO, MFA and access control.

Authentication vs Authorization

Authentication answers who the user is. Authorization defines what that user may do. An authenticated user reaching an admin function without permission is an authorization failure.

Sessions and tokens

Applications may use session cookies or tokens. JWT is a token format; OAuth 2.0 is an authorization framework; OpenID Connect adds an identity layer on top of OAuth 2.0.

SSO and MFA

Single Sign-On lets an identity be reused across applications. Multi-Factor Authentication requires additional factors and should be tested for success, failure, recovery and expiration.

QA scenarios

Validate invalid credentials, logout, expiration, role-based access, user switching, protected URLs, concurrent sessions and error messages without unnecessary disclosure.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.